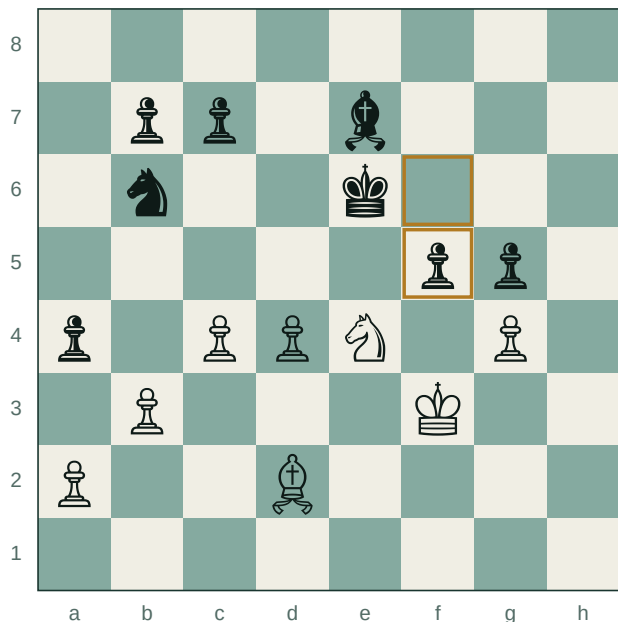


Deflection tactics: White, move 31

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 30...f5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. d5+ Kf7 32. gxf5 axb3 33. axb3

31.d5+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **31...Kf7**.

32.gxf5 The pawn captures the pawn on f5. Recorded reply: **32...axb3**.

33.axb3 The pawn captures the pawn on b3.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e6. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.